

USB Speaker Not Working: Fix Guide

Windows 10 / 11 • Try the steps in order and stop once you hear sound.

1. Set the USB speaker as the output device

This is the most common fix. Windows often keeps sending sound to another device after a USB speaker is plugged in.

1. Click the **speaker icon** at the bottom right of the taskbar.
2. Click the small arrow > next to the volume slider.
3. Pick your USB speaker from the list. It may be named "USB Audio Device" or "Speakers (USB...)".
4. Play something to test it.

2. Check volume and mute

- Check the Windows volume slider and any volume knob or button on the speaker itself.
- Right-click the speaker icon → **Volume mixer**, and make sure the app playing sound isn't muted.

3. Check that Windows detects the speaker

1. Press **Win + I**, then go to **System → Sound**.
2. If the USB speaker is listed under **Output**, select it.
3. If it isn't listed, unplug it, wait about 5 seconds, and plug it into a different USB port. Use a port directly on the PC rather than a hub or front-panel port.

4. Check that the device isn't disabled

1. On the Sound page, scroll down to **All sound devices** (on some versions, **More sound settings**).
2. If the USB speaker shows as disabled, enable it.

Note: Many USB speakers only draw power over USB and get their sound through a separate 3.5 mm audio cable. If yours has one, plug it into the PC's green headphone jack and select the headphone/Realtek output, not the USB one.

5. Run the troubleshooter

In **System → Sound**, click **Troubleshoot** next to the output device and follow the prompts.

6. Reinstall the driver

1. Right-click **Start** → **Device Manager**.
2. Expand **Sound, video and game controllers**.
3. Right-click the USB audio device → **Uninstall device**.
4. Unplug the speaker, restart the PC, and plug it back in. Windows will reinstall the driver.

Still not working?

Write down what you saw in step 3: whether the speaker appears in the Output list and what it's called. That tells you whether the issue is detection (hardware, port or driver) or just the selected output.